Samia **Menon**

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Education & Honors

University of California, Berkeley — *Berkeley, CA*

Ph.D. in Computer Science (Advised by Björn Hartmann and Marti Hearst) — *Aug. 2025 - Present*

- National Science Foundation CSGrad4US Fellow)
- Chancellor's Fellow
- EECS Excellence Award

Columbia University (School of Engineering and Applied Science) — *New York, NY*

B.S. in Computer Science with a Minor in Anthropology — *Aug. 2019 - May 2023*

- Magna Cum Laude (GPA: 3.996/4.00)
- C.P. Davis Scholar

Publications & Presentations

Under Submission

Samia Menon, Samyukta Sanjay Jayaram, Jessie Liu, Shm Almeda, Bjoern Hartmann. 2026. "We Drew Together": Designing for Dynamic Agency Negotiation in Human-AI Co-Creation. *Under review* .

Samia Menon*, Kanav Mittal*, Abigail O'Neill, Serina Chang. 2026. Whose Story Does AI Tell? Investigating LLMs as News Agents. *Under review* .

Conference and Journal Papers

Samia Menon, Sitong Wang, and Lydia B. Chilton. 2024. MoodSmith: Enabling Mood-Consistent Multimedia for AI-Generated Advocacy Campaigns. In *Proceedings of the the 15th Conference on Computational Creativity (ICCC '24),* (Jönkoping, Sweden), Association for Computational Creativity.

James Smith, **Samia Menon**, Jessie Liu, Vivian Chan, and Bjoern Hartmann. 2026. Predicting Tool Extension in VR Interactions using Gaze Features. In *Proceedings of the 39th Annual ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology (UIST '26),* (Detroit, Michigan), Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, Article 2, 1-15. https://doi.org/10.1145/3830398.3830684

Sitong Wang, **Samia Menon**, Dingzeyu Li, Xiaojuan Ma, Richard Zemel, and Lydia B Chilton. 2026. Schemex: Interactive Structural Abstraction from Examples with Contrastive Refinement. In *Proceedings of the 14th ACM Conference on Human Computation and Crowdsourcing (HCOMP '26),* (Alexandria, Virginia), Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 97-112. https://doi.org/10.1145/3834580.383874

Sinan L. Aktay, Ozan A. Aktay, **Samia Menon**, Shuo Jim Huang, Rozalina G. McCoy (In press). 2025. Supporting public transit research in healthcare settings: Testing a free, fast, and secure method for routing public transit from patient address to the point of care. In *Journal of the American Medical Informatics Association.*

Sitong Wang, **Samia Menon**, Tao Long, Keren Henderson, Dingzeyu Li, Kevin Crowston, Mark Hansen, Jeffrey V Nickerson, and Lydia B Chilton. 2024. ReelFramer: Human-AI Co-Creation for News-to-Video Translation. In *Proceedings of the 2024 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '24),* (Honolulu, Hawai'i, USA), Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, Article 169, 1–20. https://doi.org/10.1145/3613904.3642868

Tao Long, Dorothy Zhang, Grace Li, Batool Taraif, **Samia Menon**, Kynnedy Smith, Sitong Wang, Katy Gero, Lydia B. Chilton. 2023. Tweetorial Hooks: Generative AI Tools to Motivate Science on Social Media. In *Proceedings of the the 14th Conference on Computational Creativity (ICCC '23),* (Waterloo, ON, Canada), Association for Computational Creativity.

Talks

Samia Menon Designing for Dialogue: Computational Tools for Conservation Communication. 2025. Presented at *SCCS-NY*, New York, NY, USA, October 2025. (*Best Speed Talk Award: Best Use of Emerging Technologies*)

Samia Menon and Sahil Patel. Visualizing Virality. 2023. Presented at *Optimizing for What? Algorithmic Amplification and Society Symposium*, New York, NY, USA, April 2023.

Research Experience

Berkeley Institute of Design Lab (Supervised by Björn Hartmann and Marti Hearst) *Berkeley, CA*

Researcher *Aug. 2025 - present*

- Researches Human-AI interaction, specifically how algorithmically-mediated environments (social media platforms, agent interactions) re-shapes information proliferation, human behavior, and community formation.
- Applies methods in machine learning and computational social science to build systems that enhance human understanding, expression, and connection within these new paradigms.

Computational Design Lab (Supervised by Prof. Lydia Chilton) *New York, NY*

Researcher *Sep. 2022 - Apr. 2025*

- Designed, implemented, and conducted studies on system (MoodSmith) leveraging generative AI to allow non-profit organizations to effectively explore a spectrum of narrative 'moods' in their advocacy campaigns.
- Created human-AI collaborative workflows for scriptwriting and storyboarding for news-to-video translation system (ReelFramer).
- Conducted user studies to investigate efficacy of AI-supported Tweetorial Hook writing system.

Brown Institute for Media Innovation *New York, NY*

Data Visualization *Jan. 2023 - May 2023*

- Designed and implemented a data visualization investigating how virality is defined and achieved on the Twitter (now X) platform.
- Developed final app in React and p5.js.
- Presented work at the Knight First Amendment Institute's *Algorithmic Amplification and Society* symposium.

Work Experience

Squarespace *New York, NY*

Software Engineer (IC 3) *Aug. 2023 - Aug. 2025*

- Planned, organized, and lead work for major projects including coordination of multiple engineers, encompassing pioneer AI integrations and major functionality updates.
- Led work to implement 2024 Black Friday Campaign, including restructuring queuing infrastructure to create a more resilient email sending pipeline (25x faster) and developing the frontend 'playbook' experience, allowing for a record 15 million messages / day sent.
- Tackled issues in email deliverability, domains, phishing, and traffic routing.

American Museum of Natural History (AMNH) & Brown Institute for Media Innovation *New York, NY*

Experience Lead & Technologist (Volunteer) *Jan. 2024 - May 2024*

- Scoped, designed, and executed an AR experience, *Carbon Catchers*, in the Hall of Ocean life at the AMNH as a member of the leadership team behind the project.
- Designed and implemented key aspects of *Carbon Catchers*, including multiple games, user interface features, the final React application, and general visitor experience.
- Facilitated exhibit during *EarthFest 2024* (Earth Day at the Museum) to museum visitors.

Service Experience

NYC Audubon *New York, NY*

Volunteer *May. 2023 - May. 2024*

- Monitored and counted horseshoe crabs along Plumb Beach in Brooklyn, New York.

Columbia Girls Who Code *New York, NY*

VP Finance *Nov. 2019 - May 2023*

- Secured and distributed funding to support in-person computer science classes for high-school girls in the NYC area.
- Provided free MetroCards for all students for whom transportation cost was an obstacle to attendance.

Meet Me at the Museum *New York, NY*

Tour Guide *Oct. 2019 - May 2023*

- Supported free, in-person museum tours of the Metropolitan Museum of Art for NYC public elementary schools.
- Delivered free virtual art museum tours to elementary and middle school classes during the COVID-19 pandemic.

Teaching Experience

Introduction to Databases (Columbia Computer Science) *New York, NY*

Course Assistant *Aug. 2022 - Dec. 2022*

- Mentored several teams through creating a database schema, implementing their database in PostgreSQL, and creating a functional app.
- Supported instructor by holding office hours, responding to student questions online and attending virtual lecture, and grading assignments + exams.

Clean Object-Oriented Design (Columbia Computer Science) *New York, NY*

Course Assistant *Aug. 2021 - Dec. 2021*

- Held OH, created answer keys and rubrics for homework assignments, answered online questions, and graded homework assignments.

Skills

DevOps	Docker, Kubernetes, Jira, Gradle, Grafana, Google Cloud Logging
Backend	Spring, REST API, Redis Caching, MongoDB, Mockito Testing, Queue Infrastructure, DKIM/SPF Validation
Frontend	React, HTML5, CSS, Figma, A-Frame, d3.js, p5.js
Programming Languages	Java, Python, Java/Typescript, SQL, C++, MATLAB, LaTeX
Other	English (Native), French (Advanced)
	Public Speaking, UI Design, Video Editing, Illustration